



5-25-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
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Muncie Community Schools Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: May 25, 2021

Body: Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Williams called the regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board to order on Tuesday, May 25, 2021.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Heater, Mrs. Bales, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe.
 - **Absent:** Mrs. Barnes Griffin.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text prior to consent agenda).*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:25:12 Recommendation for Certified Staff Compensation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Heater, on behalf of the CEO's Subcommittee for Compensation.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Heater reported on recommendations resulting from increased state legislative funding. The plan aims to continue reducing teacher turnover and boosting pay:
 - Establishes a minimum base pay for certified teaching staff of **\$42,000** (up from \$38,500).
 - Teachers with 1<U+2013>4 years of experience receive a base salary increase of **\$4,300**.
 - Teachers with 5<U+2013>10 years of experience receive a base salary increase of **\$4,200** plus an additional **\$1,000** catch-up increment (total **\$5,200**).
 - Teachers with 11<U+2013>19 years of experience receive a **\$5,000** increase (including a \$1,000 catch-up adjustment).
 - Teachers with 20+ years of experience receive a **\$3,400** increase (including a \$1,000 base adjustment).
 - Total estimated cost is **\$1,346,900**. Staff and administrative pay adjustments will be addressed subsequently in August (retroactive to contract start).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:31:55 Roof Bid Award (Northview Elementary & Southside Middle School)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Facilities team.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Bids were received on May 18 for roof replacement projects at Northview Elementary and two sections at Muncie Southside Middle School (dating back to the mid-1980s). The low bid was submitted by McGuff Roofing (Muncie, IN) for **\$561,280**, which came in under the architect's estimate. Funded via the construction bond fund.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:33:40 Revision of Flexible Physical Education Credits

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds requested authorization to expand the current practice allowing Central High School students to earn *one* flexible PE credit to earning *two* flexible PE credits through qualifying activities (IHSA sanctioned sports, MCJROTC, and summer marching band/guard), utilizing two separate activities. Guidance counselors and Mr. Walker recommended the change to give students greater course flexibility.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion: Mrs. Bales; Second: Mr. Irvin).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:05:12 Matthew Pifer** (Substitute Teacher & Founder of “The Voice for Kids”): Spoke regarding childhood trauma and advocated for implementing the **“Handle with Care”** program in Muncie schools. The initiative connects law enforcement agencies and schools so teachers are notified when a child has experienced a police-involved traumatic incident, without details of the event being disclosed, allowing for better trauma-informed support and mental health coordination (e.g., Meridian Services). Superintendent Dr. Kowalski noted a scheduled meeting in June with Judges Kim Dowling and Amanda Yanley to discuss this exact program.
 - **00:10:42 Beth** (Muncie Public Library): Voiced support for the “Handle with Care” program and requested that notification protocols be extended to after-school care and after-care providers.
 - **00:11:40 Coach Doric Lee** (Head Football Coach, Muncie Central High School): Celebrated academic and scholarship achievements of the football team (noting 17 players received awards, 12 are in the top 10 of their class, and 6 are signing with universities with zero loan debt). Submitted a wish list request for a **Jugs football machine** (priced at \$2,995) to assist multiple position groups and protect quarterbacks’ arms.
 - **00:14:49 Michelle Stark** (Football Booster / Parent): Expressed gratitude for Coach Lee’s positive impact on students. Raised concerns regarding student perceptions that upper school administration and athletic management do not support athletic programs or student-athletes, citing a specific instance where a student athlete felt blocked or dismissed regarding track participation. Board leadership invited specific details to be brought to Dr. Kowalski, emphasizing a strict zero-retaliation policy for student grievances.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Device pick-up and refresh operations are ongoing across K-12 schools, with Virtual Learning Program (VLP) tent drop-offs beginning Thursday across city spots and a central station at 400 South Walnut Street.
 - Summer workouts for athletics begin June 3rd.
 - Board members and administrators commended faculty, staff, and leadership for successfully navigating a full face-to-face academic year amidst pandemic challenges.
- **Adjournment:** Approved by Voice Vote.

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